CONNOR DE THOMASIS

Cyber Security & AI Analyst | Security & GRC | Blue Team

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PROFILE

Information Technology student at QUT majoring in Cyber Security with a second major in Artificial Intelligence, with project experience across security risk assessment, incident response planning, and the design of AI guardrails. I have pride in my work and always look at how I can improve with a growth mindset focused on learning new skills through research and homelabbing. I have translated technical findings into budgeted and prioritised recommendations for non-technical stakeholders. I perform reliably under pressure with close attention to detail and am excited to apply academic knowledge and theory to real-world practice while completing my studies.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Information Technology | *Queensland University of Technology, Gardens Point* *Feb 2025 - Present*

- Major in Cyber Security | Second Major in Artificial Intelligence. Expected graduation December 2027.

Secondary Graduation Certificate | *Holy Spirit College, Mackay (Mount Pleasant)* *Graduated Nov 2024*

- Awarded Year 12 Academic Excellence.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security & GRC: Security risk assessment, control effectiveness review, network segmentation review, business impact analysis, incident response planning, NIST SP 800-61, Privacy Act 1988 & Notifiable Data Breaches scheme

AI Security: LLM guardrail design, prompt injection & jailbreak defence, adversarial testing, Azure OpenAI

Programming & Systems: Python, SQL, C#, Git (GitHub), Linux & Windows, Command Line Interface (CLI), Microsoft Azure

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Work Experience (School-Based) | *Mackay Regional Council* *2023 & 2024*

- Completed two separate one-week placements in the IT department of a regional local government organisation, arranged through Holy Spirit College.
- Sat with professionals across network engineering, systems engineering, endpoint engineering and help desk, IT operations, governance and digital transformation, and cyber security engineering.
- Gained early exposure to how a live enterprise IT environment divides infrastructure, service delivery, governance and security responsibilities across specialist roles.

Crew Member | *McDonald's, North Mackay* *Mar 2022 - Jan 2025*

- Trained and supported new crew members through onboarding, reinforcing food safety procedures and cleaning standards across the full back-of-house preparation process.
- Delivered front-line customer service throughout sustained high-volume periods, maintaining accuracy and composure under time pressure.
- Applied strict food safety and compliance procedures consistently across shifts in a fast-paced operating environment.

CERTIFICATIONS & LICENCES

- CompTIA Security+ Certification (In Progress).
- Valid P2 Provisional Driver's Licence (Manual).

PROJECTS

Detection Engineering Home Lab (In Progress) | *Personal Project* *July 2026 - Present*

- Designing and building a segmented detection engineering lab on Proxmox VE to host a Windows Active Directory domain, a Wazuh single-node SIEM and deliberately vulnerable targets, with pfSense isolating lab and host networks.
- Next stage: emulate attack activity from a Kali VM, map it to MITRE ATT&CK, and use the resulting telemetry to author and tune custom detection rules against real signal rather than synthetic samples.
- Backed the environment with ZFS mirrored storage and have planned UPS-managed graceful shutdown to protect lab data and preserve detection history across power events.

Secure Topic-Constrained AI Chatbot with Layered Guardrails | *Queensland University of Technology May 2026*

- Built a multi-turn chatbot in Python on Azure OpenAI (GPT-4.1-mini, text-embedding-ada-002) wrapping every turn in a six-layer guardrail pipeline: token cap, normalised keyword denylist, embedding similarity against 26 jailbreak archetypes, topic-anchor similarity, and an LLM-as-a-Judge on both input and output.
- Judge verdicts deny rather than pass through, and returned generic refusals to the user while writing the triggering layer, category and similarity scores to a rotating JSON audit log, denying attackers the feedback needed to tune bypasses.
- Tested against prompt-injection, persona-escape, system-prompt-extraction and obfuscation attacks with no successful bypasses across 50+ logged decisions.

Information Security Risk Assessment - Hospitality Group | *Queensland University of Technology Mar 2026*

- Owned network infrastructure as one of six assessed assets for a simulated 10-property hotel group, identifying a flat network architecture as a Critical inherent risk (20) for organisation-wide ransomware propagation and scoring it against a semi-quantitative 5x5 likelihood and impact matrix.
- Reviewed existing segmentation, client isolation and offsite backup controls to justify a reduced residual rating, then costed and recommended endpoint detection and response and multi-factor authentication rollouts across 1,100 devices for selection into a budget-constrained year-one treatment plan.

Business Impact Analysis & Incident Response Plan | *Queensland University of Technology May 2026*

- Completed the business impact analysis for the EDR and SIEM platform, quantifying financial, operational and reputational impact, mapping cloud and network dependencies. Identified single points of failure to justify Priority 1 recovery ranking.
- Contributed to a NIST SP 800-61 aligned incident response plan defining SEV 1-3 severity classification and response times, incident response team roles and pre-authorised actions, and OAIC notifiable data breach escalation triggers.

REFEREES

Available upon request.